

Career Challenge: Time Management for MedTech Students

1. Time Audit: Current Situation

Currently, I am balancing multiple significant commitments alongside the Carisurg Healthcare AI program. These include developing a Hurricane system and managing my personal startup venture. This combination of responsibilities means my available time is more constrained than the typical program participant. Rather than viewing this as a limitation, I see it as an opportunity to develop efficient time management strategies that will serve me well in my future career.

Over the past two weeks, I have been able to dedicate approximately 1-2 hours per day to the Carisurg program, primarily working in the evening hours. This timing works well for me personally, as I find my energy and focus tend to improve later in the day. Mornings are typically lower energy periods for me, which is an important factor in planning my schedule going forward.

2. Identifying My Energy Patterns

Through self-reflection, I have identified that my green hours, representing peak productivity, occur in the evening between 7:00 PM and 11:00 PM. During these hours, I can focus deeply on technical work and problem-solving. My yellow hours, where I can accomplish meaningful work but with less intensity, occur in the afternoon from 2:00 PM to 5:00 PM. My red hours, characterized by lower energy, are typically in the morning from early wake-up until around noon.

Understanding this pattern is crucial for my time management strategy. Rather than forcing myself to be productive during low-energy periods, I can align my most demanding tasks with my evening green hours. This approach respects my natural rhythms and maximizes the quality of work I can produce in limited time.

3. Framework Application: The Eisenhower Matrix

I have selected the Eisenhower Matrix as my primary framework for managing competing priorities. Given that I am simultaneously handling a startup, the Hurricane system development, and the Carisurg program, having a clear prioritization system is essential. The

matrix helps me distinguish between what is truly urgent and important versus tasks that merely feel urgent due to external pressures.

For my context, Quadrant 1 (Urgent and Important) contains time-sensitive Carisurg deliverables and critical startup tasks. Quadrant 2 (Important but Not Urgent) includes skill development through the Carisurg curriculum and long-term planning for both my startup and the Hurricane system. Quadrants 3 and 4 are minimized to protect my limited productive hours for meaningful work.

4. Implementation Strategy

My implementation strategy is straightforward and realistic: I work on Carisurg program tasks when I have the opportunity, which naturally occurs in the evenings. Because the program content is directly relevant to my startup work in healthcare, there is strong synergy between these commitments. The technical skills and knowledge I gain through Carisurg directly benefit my entrepreneurial goals, making the time investment mutually reinforcing.

Currently, I am committing approximately 7-14 hours per week to the program (1-2 hours daily), which represents a realistic allocation given my other responsibilities. I aim to increase this gradually by improving my efficiency and protecting more green hour time for focused work.

5. Areas for Improvement and Commitments

Based on the insights from the career challenge session, I recognize two key areas for improvement. First, I commit to establishing a more consistent sleep schedule by going to bed at a reasonable hour. Adequate rest is essential for maintaining the cognitive performance needed for both my program work and startup responsibilities. Second, I aim to dedicate more focused time to the Carisurg program as my other projects stabilize.

The session emphasized that consistency beats intensity, and that success comes from systems that work even on difficult days. My system is built around seizing opportunities when they arise and making progress incrementally. This approach has served me well in managing multiple ventures simultaneously.

6. Why This Approach Works for Me

This approach is realistic for my current life situation. Rather than pretending I have unlimited time or energy, I am acknowledging my constraints and working within them effectively. The Eisenhower Matrix helps me prioritize across multiple important projects, while my evening-focused schedule aligns with my natural energy patterns. The connection between Carisurg and my startup creates positive motivation, as learning in one area directly benefits the other.

I am giving my best effort given the circumstances, and I remain committed to making meaningful progress through the program. As the session noted, motivation may be unreliable, but having a clear purpose and connection to real-world goals provides sustainable drive. My startup and the Hurricane system represent my future, and the Carisurg program is helping me build the skills to succeed in that future.